

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

GRAND CROSSING STABBINGS

Suspect found in Indiana

Man accused of killing his girlfriend, injuring 2 boys

By Deanese Williams-Harris,
Caroline Kubzansky
and Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

When Malik Wilson arrived at Comer Children's Hospital to check on his 11-year-old nephew who was stabbed six times Thursday night, the boy couldn't speak. But he was able to move his hand from his hospital bed when he heard his family's voices, Wilson said Friday outside the hospital.

"It's devastating," Wilson said. "I never expected this."

Indiana police on Friday said they arrested a man suspected of stabbing his girlfriend and her two sons, 11-year-old Darius Gaters and 8-year-old Tristan Gaters, in the Grand Crossing neighborhood on Chicago's South Side hours earlier. Teone Jones, the 33-year-old "great mom" and "beautiful soul," was killed and her sons



Police in Indiana arrest a 39-year-old man Friday along a stretch of Interstate 65. The man is suspected in the fatal stabbing of a 33-year-old woman and the kidnapping of an 8-year-old boy in Chicago. LAKE COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE

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Chicago's frigid temperatures this week make Lake Michigan just right for competitive ice swimmer Qing Li, who holds a world record in the sport



NOT EVEN BREAKING A SWEAT

By Carolyn Stein | Chicago Tribune

Qing Li always wanted to compete in the Olympics.

The 35-year-old grew up surrounded by swimming greats and even got to meet a few Olympic swimmers before she turned 10. From a young age, Li competed in swim club and continued the sport all the way through college. But it was not until Li was 32 when she would finally win a gold medal on a world stage in France.

Except, that gold medal was not for the Olympic swimming, but for ice swimming at the International Ice Swimming Association's world championship.

Li, who lives in downtown Chicago, is one of nearly a hundred American athletes competing in the growing sport of ice swimming, where people traverse frigid waters of 41 degrees or lower with nothing but a swimsuit, goggles and a swimming cap. She will compete in one of those chilly competitions this weekend at Lake Memphremagog in Vermont.

Qing Li, top, gets ready to swim at Promontory Point at sunrise in Chicago on Sunday. The water was 32 degrees, according to year-round swimmer Bill Stamets, who accompanies Li and measures the temperature every morning. Li will compete in an ice swimming meet this weekend in Vermont. AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Over 700 people from more than 40 countries compete in ice swimming, with competitors coming from Germany, Italy, China and even Mexico. In the U.S., there are ice swimmers from across the country — from states that experience colder climates such as Illinois, Indiana and Massachusetts to states known for warmer weather such as Arizona, Texas and California. The International Ice Swimming Association held its first official national U.S. competition last year and as interest in the sport continues to grow, the association is pushing for the sport to be included in the Olympics.

When training for competitions around this time of year — Chicago saw wind chills of about 20 below this week — Li practices in an indoor pool to work on her speed and endurance. However, she will occasionally hop into Lake Michigan to get acclimated to the water, sometimes bringing a hammer to hack through the ice with if the lake has frozen over. Last weekend, Li hopped into the lake around sunrise — on days where Chicago saw snow and temps drop into the single digits.

Li started doing open water swimming when she was 14. She swam her first open water 3K event in 2014 — and completely hated it.

"I went in, I swam it, I got out and said, 'Never again. This was horrible. Like, I don't know why people do

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USAID CUTS

Judge clears way for layoffs

Ruling could start clock on 30-day deadline for those abroad to leave their posts

By Ellen Knickmeyer
and Lindsay Whitehurst
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — A federal judge cleared the way Friday for the Trump administration to pull thousands of U.S. Agency for International Development staffers off the job.

U.S. District Judge Carl Nichols removed his temporary block on the effort to remove all but a small fraction of USAID staffers from their posts and give those abroad a 30-day deadline to move back to the U.S. at government expense.

His ruling comes in a lawsuit filed by unions on behalf of workers. They say the rush to dismantle the agency had cut off some staffers overseas from emergency communications systems, including some in danger of political violence in Congo.

Nichols found that the unions' challenge must be dealt with under federal employment laws rather than in district court.

The Trump administration and the cost-cutting Department of Government Efficiency tied to billionaire Elon Musk have moved swiftly to shutter USAID, asserting that its work is wasteful and out of line with the president's agenda.

Staffers, however, assert that the courts' temporary blocks have had only limited effect in slowing the Trump administration's dismantling of USAID and have left some USAID workers

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FUNDING FREEZE: A federal judge could further block President Donald Trump's administration from freezing trillions of dollars of grants and loans that fund everything from clean energy programs to bridge repairs to emergency shelters. **Nation & World**

JERRY 'ICEMAN' BUTLER
1939-2025

Hall of Fame vocalist had second life as politician

By Bob Goldsborough
Chicago Tribune

Jerry "Iceman" Butler went from street-corner singing and belting out gospel songs in church to co-founding the popular vocal R&B group the Impressions, which was inducted into the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame in 1991.

Although Butler's time in the Impressions only lasted a few years, he enjoyed many years of success afterward as a songwriter and as a solo singer with a rich, creamy smooth baritone voice, penning and performing numerous tunes that found success including "He Will Break Your Heart," "Hey, Western Union Man" and "Only the Strong Survive."

While Butler never fully abandoned music, he had a full life outside of it, running a beverage distribution business and serving as a Cook County Board member for 32 years, stepping down in 2018.



Butler

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